

Device Usage Policy – IT Asset Management

Effective Date: August 1, 2024

Owner: IT Department

1. Covered Devices

1.1 This policy applies to all Company-owned devices including laptops, desktop computers, company-issued smartphones, tablets, monitors, docking stations, and any external storage devices (USB drives, external hard drives) purchased with Company funds.

1.2 Personal devices used for work purposes are covered only when accessing Company resources via approved methods (browser-based VDI), and employees assume all risk for data on personal devices.

2. Permitted Software and Installation

2.1 Employees may only install software on Company laptops that is listed on the approved software catalog. The catalog includes: Microsoft Office, Slack, Zoom, Google Chrome, Visual Studio Code, Git, Docker, and antivirus software (pre-installed).

2.2 Installing unapproved software – including unauthorized games, file-sharing clients (BitTorrent), remote access tools (TeamViewer, AnyDesk not provided by IT), or beta/unstable operating system versions – is prohibited.

2.3 If an employee requires software not on the catalog, they must submit a software request ticket to IT. IT will evaluate security and licensing requirements, and respond within 3 business days.

3. Personal Use of Company Devices

3.1 Limited personal use of Company devices is permitted as long as it does not:

- a) Interfere with job performance or availability during working hours,
- b) Violate any law or Company policy (e.g., accessing adult content, gambling, pirating software),
- c) Create a hostile work environment (e.g., displaying offensive images or language), or
- d) Create security vulnerabilities (e.g., installing unapproved personal apps on a company phone).

3.2 Personal use must not consume excessive bandwidth or storage. Streaming video for non-business purposes is limited to lunch breaks or after work hours.

3.3 Employees have no expectation of privacy when using Company devices. IT may audit devices at any time, including reviewing installed software, browsing history (to the extent collected), and file contents.

4. Lost or Stolen Devices

4.1 If a Company device is lost or stolen, the employee must report the incident to IT immediately (within 1 hour of discovery) by calling the IT hotline at ext. 1234 or emailing it-support@company.com.

4.2 The report must include: device type and serial number (if known), last known location, approximate time of loss, and whether the device was powered on or had any saved passwords.

4.3 Upon receiving the report, IT will remotely lock and wipe the device if it is a laptop or smartphone. Data may not be recoverable, but this action is necessary to protect Company information.

4.4 Failure to report a lost device within 24 hours may result in a \$50 administrative fee. Intentional concealment of loss may lead to disciplinary action.

5. Security Settings and Hygiene

5.1 Screen locks must activate after 5 minutes of inactivity. The lock must require a password, PIN, or biometric (fingerprint, face ID) to unlock.

5.2 Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and contain a mix of uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols. Password reuse across personal accounts is discouraged.

5.3 Full-disk encryption is mandatory on all laptops. IT enables this by default; employees must not disable it.

5.4 Devices must run security updates within 7 days of notification. After 14 days without update, network access may be restricted until the update is applied.

6. Returning Devices Upon Departure

6.1 Upon termination of employment or contract, all Company devices must be returned to IT within 5 business days. The employee will receive a checklist of items to return.

6.2 Any device not returned will result in a deduction from the final paycheck equal to the depreciated value of the device (for employees) or an invoice sent to the vendor company (for contractors).

6.3 Before returning, employees must not attempt to wipe or factory reset the device themselves. IT will handle secure data deletion after return.